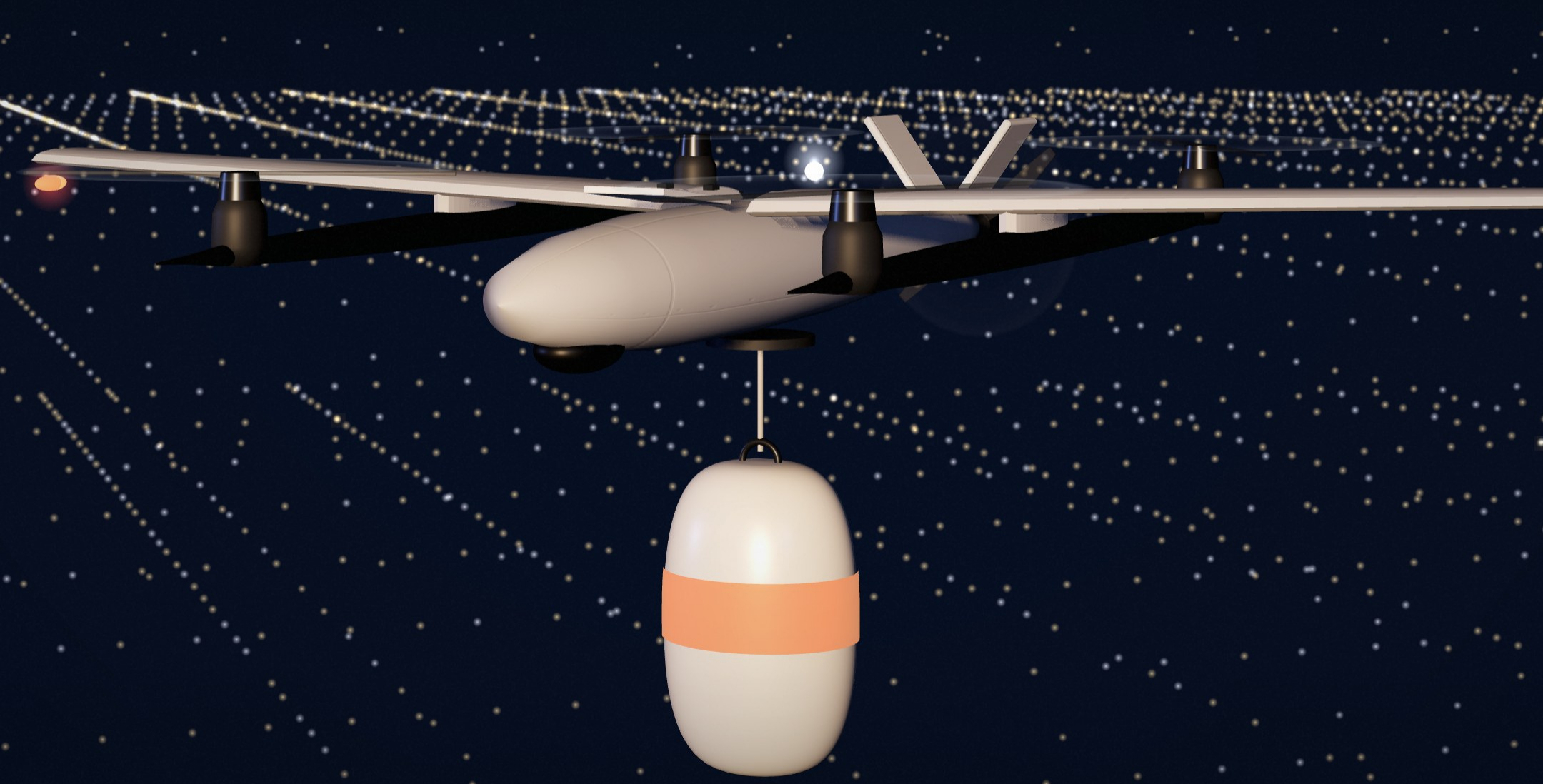
The drones came first

Zipline began taking orders in Round Rock on October 9th, DroneXL reports. The City of Round Rock says its zoning ordinances don’t specifically address drone delivery hubs. The aircraft is drawn to illustrate.



The first hub is outside city limits

Round Rock places the facility near North Kenney Fort and Joe DiMaggio Boulevards, in its extraterritorial jurisdiction. Citing the company, the city says service reaches eligible customers within three miles. The tower and aircraft are drawn to illustrate.



The city can't regulate the flight path

Round Rock says the FAA regulates airspace and flight paths. Its page says drones may fly over residential areas on approved routes. Inside city limits it may regulate where drone infrastructure sits. The aircraft is drawn to illustrate.



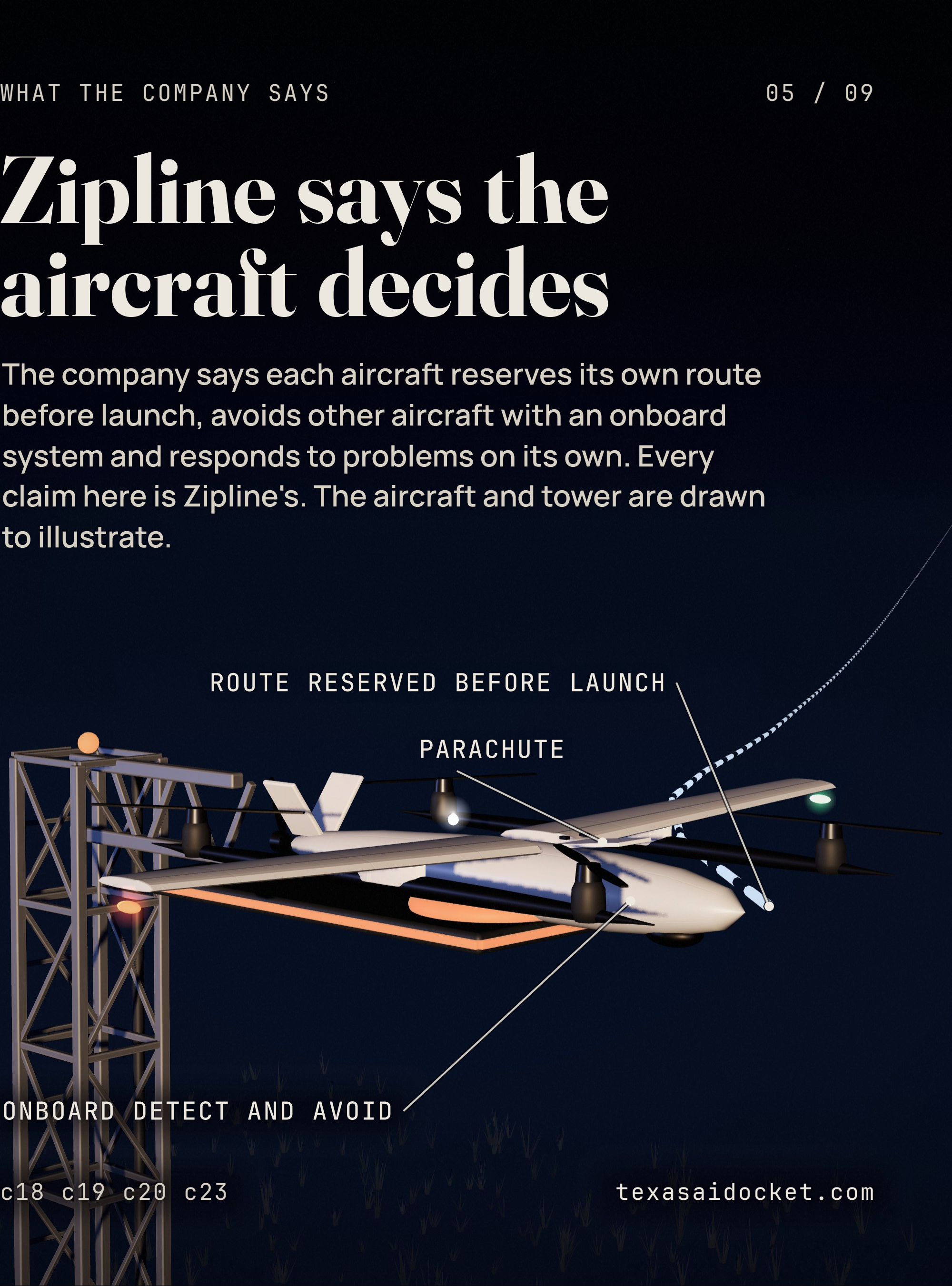
Three miles from the hub

Citing the company, the city says service reaches within three miles of the hub. A circle that wide covers about 28.3 square miles, computed here. The ring is drawn to illustrate.



Zipline says the aircraft decides

The company says each aircraft reserves its own route before launch, avoids other aircraft with an onboard system and responds to problems on its own. Every claim here is Zipline's. The aircraft and tower are drawn to illustrate.



People watch from somewhere else

Zipline says trained staff monitor its flights from a remote operations center. The room is drawn to illustrate.



Rowlett wrote the rule first, DroneXL reports

Rowlett’s minutes record a 6 to 0 vote adding drone hubs and kiosks to its zoning code on May 20th, 2025. Zipline was the applicant. In the minutes a member says the hub’s special use permit "is the control." The chamber is drawn with one microphone per vote cast.



The neighbor gets an email address

Round Rock directs operational feedback to Zipline at community@zipline.com and safety concerns to the FAA. Citing Community Impact, DroneXL reports a limit of about 5 pounds per order, lowered on a tether. The pod and yard are drawn to illustrate.



Next, the hub comes before the rule

Round Rock is working with Zipline toward a hub behind Renaissance Square on northbound Interstate 35. The city says that site will help it develop regulations for future facilities inside city limits. Drawn to illustrate.

